

Curator Choice Gallery Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 30-40 min

Category	The Arts	Time	30-40 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	curator-choice-gallery

Big idea: Curators do not only display knowledge in the arts; they help organize and produce it.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students arrange the same artworks in different gallery sequences and analyze how curation creates meaning.

Student Prompt

Inspect Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Artwork set: empty chair, crowded street, broken cup, bright abstract pattern, family photo, dark landscape. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Curatorial themes: loss, modern life, beauty in ordinary objects, uncertainty, memory. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Curator Choice Gallery Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Curatorial themes: loss, modern life, beauty in ordinary objects, uncertainty, memory. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Curators do not only display knowledge in the arts; they help organize and produce it.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Curator Choice Gallery Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
6	How do institutions shape knowledge in the arts?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how curators do not only display knowledge in the arts; they help organize and produce it.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: How do institutions shape knowledge in the arts?

Setup Checklist

- Use image cards or brief descriptions; the activity does not require famous artworks.
- Give each group a different curatorial theme so the same works become different arguments.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Artwork set: empty chair, crowded street, broken cup, bright abstract pattern, family photo, dark landscape.
- Curatorial themes: loss, modern life, beauty in ordinary objects, uncertainty, memory.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/curator-choice-gallery/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/curator-choice-gallery/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/curator-choice-gallery/visual-prompt.svg>
- Gallery floor-plan template with numbered artwork spaces.
- Wall-label card: title, placement reason, connection to previous work.

Run Sequence

1. Give groups the same artwork cards and a different curatorial theme.
2. Groups arrange the works in a sequence and write a title for the gallery.
3. Students add two wall labels explaining key choices.
4. Groups tour each gallery and record how the sequence changed meaning.
5. Debrief curation as interpretation, argument, and knowledge production.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: How do institutions shape knowledge in the arts?
- Can arrangement change what an artwork means?
- What responsibility does a curator have to viewers and artists?

Teacher Quick Script

- A gallery sequence is an argument the viewer walks through.
- What did your arrangement make the audience notice first?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...